

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Gowthami Velagapudi

Address: 8 Sandringham Court 11 Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6NG

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Planning Officer,

I wish to object to the proposed conversion of the former ambulance station into a community centre/prayer facility.

Traffic and Parking:

The proposal allows for up to approximately 160 attendees at a time with multiple daily gatherings. The surrounding roads including Dorset Road, Belmore Way and Downs Avenue already have limited parking capacity, which is further used by:

Southdown Nursing Home (approx. 25-29 residents) relying on both on-site and street parking

- Downs Tennis Club (~80 members)

- Sutton Bowling Club (500+ members)

Both clubs host matches, social events and family gatherings, increasing visitor parking demand.

- Local residents also depend on on-street parking for their own visitors, meaning capacity is already heavily utilised.

Road Network Constraint - Dorset Road (LTN / No-Through Route):

Dorset Road operates as a low-traffic, no-through residential road in Belmont, designed to prevent rat-running and reduce vehicle flow.

Introducing a high-intensity use generating repeated traffic inflows is incompatible with this design purpose.

Highway Safety:

The road already experiences:

daily school drop-off and pick-up activity from parents and carers of Avenue School pupils
cycle use and 24/7 motorbike movements
pedestrian use by children, elderly residents and sports club users
Additional traffic will increase pedestrian conflict and accident risk.

Existing Collision Risk - Evidence Base:

Causeway CollisionMap (2022-2024) shows police-recorded injury collisions in the immediate area, including near school routes and Dorset Road junctions, demonstrating an existing baseline safety risk which the proposal would worsen.

Noise, Late-Night Disturbance and Amenity:

The proposal would result in:

- groups congregating and talking on the street
- late-night dispersal noise (including around 11pm)
- vehicle movements and congestion

This would disturb residents and vulnerable care home occupants.

Loss of Privacy and Overlooking:

The proposed use would lead to regular congregation of large numbers of people near neighbouring homes, resulting in:

overlooking of homes, windows and gardens

late-evening presence affecting privacy

vehicles waiting outside residential properties

This represents a material loss of privacy for residents and care home occupants.

Sensitive Receptor - Care Home Impact:

The site adjoins Southdown Nursing Home (5 Dorset Road) caring for elderly and dementia residents (approx. 25-29).

The application indicates:

- late dispersal peaks up to approx. 250 people
- overspill parking up to 69 vehicles
- This creates disturbance, obstruction and emergency access risk.

Environmental Impact and Sustainability Concerns:

The proposal would introduce significant additional traffic and activity causing:

- increased air pollution and idling emissions
- noise pollution
- reduced safety for walking and cycling
- increased litter and waste
- conflict with low-traffic neighbourhood objectives

Wider Local and Cumulative Impact on the Area:

The surrounding area already accommodates Avenue School, Southdown Nursing Home, Downs Tennis Club and Sutton Bowling Club, alongside residential homes.

The proposal would introduce a further high-intensity, high-footfall use, leading to cumulative impacts including:

- increased traffic and congestion throughout the day and evening
 - overlapping peak periods (school times, weekends and club events)
 - greater pressure on residential streets and infrastructure
- obstruction to deliveries, refuse collection and emergency access
- increased footfall and congregation in residential streets

a shift in character from a quiet residential environment to a high-activity destination use

- This would harm the character and functioning of the local neighbourhood.

Existing Community Facility Provision:

There is already a local facility at St John the Baptist Church, demonstrating that community uses are already accommodated locally in suitable premises.

Conflict with Planning Policy:

The proposal conflicts with:

London Plan T4 (Transport impacts)

London Plan D14 (Noise and amenity)

London Plan SI1 (Air quality)

London Plan T2 (Healthy Streets / low traffic)

London Plan GG3 (Health and wellbeing)

Local plan policies on residential amenity, privacy, highway safety and appropriate scale

Conclusion:

For the reasons above, the proposal would cause unacceptable highway, environmental, privacy and local impact harm, and should therefore be refused.